

BKM 5 Enrichment

E1. 1 Nephi 16:6 “as my Father dwelt in a tent”:

Hugh Nibley said, “Nephi ... refers constantly to his father’s tent as the center of his universe. To an Arab, ‘My father dwelt in a tent’ says everything... ‘So with the announcement that his father dwelt in a tent, Nephi serves notice that he had assumed the desert way of life, as perforce he must for his journey: any easterner would appreciate the significance and importance of the statement, which to us seems almost trivial. If Nephi seems to think of his father’s tent as the hub of everything, he is simply expressing the view of any normal Bedouin (Arabian tent dweller).” ([*Lehi in the Desert and The World of the Jaredites*, 57-58](#). Online search Chapter 3, Into the Desert for the word “tent”. If you are reading the text online, the browser Safari search box at the top, at the very left of the search box, often presents an icon with horizontal lines, which you can click on to make reading the text, much larger and much easier.)

E2. 1 Nephi 16:10 “a round ball of curious workmanship”:

Elder David A. Bednar: “Just as Lehi was blessed in ancient times, each of us in this day has been given a spiritual compass that can direct and instruct us during our mortal journey. The Holy Ghost was conferred upon you and me as we came out of the world and into the Savior’s Church through baptism and confirmation. By the authority of the holy priesthood we were confirmed as members of the Church and admonished to seek for the constant companionship of ‘the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you’ (John 14:17).

“As we press forward along the pathway of life, we receive direction from the Holy Ghost just as Lehi was directed through the Liahona. ‘For behold, again I say unto you that if ye will enter in by the way, and receive the Holy Ghost, it will show unto you all things what ye should do.

“The Holy Ghost operates in our lives precisely as the Liahona did for Lehi and his family, according to our faith and diligence and heed.” (“[That We May Always Have His Spirit to Be with Us](#),” *Ensign*, May 2006, 30-31)

E3. “Small and Simple Things”:

Elder M. Russell Ballard: “While having these tender, spiritual experiences this past month, I was sobered by how small and simple things can be negative and destructive to a person’s salvation. A series of seemingly small but incorrect choices can become those little soul-destroying termites that eat away at the foundations of our testimony until, before we are aware, we may be brought near to spiritual and moral destruction.

This past month, one of the missionaries who served with Sister Ballard and me in Canada shared the details of how small things can compound into near destruction unless the course is corrected. He wrote:

“When I returned from my mission, I married and went to work in the construction industry. Over the next few years we had three children, and during this time I

remained active in the Church. The demands of my business became much greater, and I became more determined to do whatever it would take to succeed financially. The effects of this were felt immediately at home; but with the support of an understanding wife, we felt we could endure until things ‘picked up.’”

He went on to say that because of financial strains, his wife began working. He began working long hours and neglected his family and Church duties. His demanding work schedule left him emotionally drained and physically exhausted. He became critical of others, including his family members and Church leaders.

His letter continues:

“As my debt continued to mount, the destruction of my peace and happiness increased. The love and tenderness we once knew as husband and wife had diminished to only memories. We found character flaws in each other and began to focus on them, wounding each other over the smallest incident. I began to blame everyone but myself, taking no responsibility for failures. A great feeling of hopelessness began to fill my heart, and I felt a cloud of darkness envelop me in my desperation.

“We knew our marriage could not endure under such conditions and began to talk in terms of divorce. I decided to get some financial counseling; and after reviewing my finances, it became the joke that I was worth more dead than alive, which seemed funny and rather innocent at the time. After continuing for a few more weeks, the threat of divorce as well as the very real threat of complete financial collapse seemed only a matter of time. The innocent joke of being worth more dead than alive developed into the appearance of a very real solution. I found myself alone at home, facing the crossroads of my decision. The thought came to me to reach out to the Lord one last time. Kneeling, I wept uncontrollably as I cried to the Lord for his mercy and help in my desperate hour.

“A few minutes later, word came that my mission president was in town and wanted to see me in an hour. As I sat with you, I wanted to hide my problems as I had done from everyone else. But your questions came, asking:

“‘How are you?’

“‘Fine.’

“‘How is your wife?’

“‘Doing good.’

“‘How are the children?’

“‘Great.’

“Then came the pause, and you looked into my eyes and asked, ‘How is your business?’ I began to weep as I told you my story.

“During the course of our meeting, you asked me to make you a promise: that I would read the Book of Mormon. After committing to you that I would, you blessed me, telling me to rivet myself to the gospel and to keep the commandments. I left you knowing the Lord had heard my plea for help.”

Can you see, brothers and sisters, how many small and simple things took their toll in the life of this fine

young man? Like weak fibers that form a yarn, then a strand, and finally a rope, these small things combined together can become too strong to be broken. We must ever be aware of the power that the small and simple things can have in building spirituality. At the same time, we must be aware that Satan will use small and simple things to lead us into despair and misery. (“[Small and Simple Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 1990.)

E4. 1 Nephi 16:18. A Bow “Made of Fine Steel”: One commentator explained the use of steel in the Book of Mormon: “The overall question of the use of metals by Book of Mormon cultures is an important topic that deserves detailed attention [see John Sorenson, *An Ancient American Setting for the Book of Mormon* (1985), 277–88]. ... There are five explicit references to metal weapons and armor in the Book of Mormon. Two are references to Near East weapons: ‘the blade [of Laban’s sword] was of the most precious steel’ ([1 Nephi 4:9](#)), and Nephi’s bow was made of ‘fine steel’ ([1 Nephi 16:18](#)). The existence of steel (that is, carburized iron) weapons in the Near East in the early sixth century B.C. has been clearly demonstrated. Robert Maddin writes, ‘To sum up, by the beginning of the seventh century B.C. at the latest, the blacksmiths of the eastern Mediterranean had mastered two of the processes that make iron a useful material for tools and weapons: carburizing and quenching’ [“How the Iron Age Began,” *Scientific American*, Oct. 1977: 131]” (William J. Hamblin and A. Brent Merrill, “Swords in the Book of Mormon,” in *Warfare in the Book of Mormon*, ed. Stephen D. Ricks and William J. Hamblin [1990], 345–46; cited in [Book of Mormon Student Manual](#): Click on Chapter 5 and do a Google page search using a short phrase from this passage).

E5. 1 Nephi 16:21–25. The Broken Bow Experience Elder Neal A. Maxwell shared how great lessons often come after difficulties: “Nephi’s broken bow doubtless brought to him some irritation, but not immobilizing bitterness. After all, he was just trying to feed the extended family, so why should he have to contend as well with a broken bow? Yet out of that episode came a great teaching moment. Irritation often precedes instruction” (*If Thou Endure It Well* [1996], 128).

Elder Richard G. Scott: “May I share some suggestions with you who face ... the testing that a wise Heavenly Father determines is needed even when you are living a worthy, righteous life and are obedient to His commandments.

“Just when all seems to be going right, challenges often come in multiple doses applied simultaneously. When those trials are not consequences of your disobedience, they are evidence that the Lord feels you are prepared to grow more (see Proverbs 3:11–12). He therefore gives you experiences that stimulate growth, understanding, and compassion which polish you for your everlasting benefit. To get you from where you are to where He wants you to be requires a lot of stretching, and that generally entails discomfort and pain” (“[Trust in](#)

[the Lord](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 16–17) *Ensign*, Nov. 1995, 16–17; cited in [Book of Mormon Student Manual](#): Click on Chapter 5 and do a Google page search using a short phrase from this passage).).

E6. Elder Robert D. Hales: “I have come to understand how useless it is to dwell on the *whys*, *what ifs*, and *if onlys* for which there likely will be given no answers in mortality. To receive the Lord’s comfort, we must exercise faith. The questions Why me? Why our family? Why now? Are usually unanswerable questions. These questions detract from our spirituality and can destroy our faith. We need to spend our time and energy building our faith by turning to the Lord and asking for strength to overcome the pains and trials of this world and to endure to the end for greater understanding.” (“[Healing Soul and Body](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1998, 14–15)

E7. 1 Nephi 16:34. “The Place Which Was Called Nahom”: The Hebrew meaning of nahom might be “consolation,” from the verb nahom, which means to “be sorry, console oneself.” An *Ensign* news article described an archaeological find that revealed the name Nahom in the Arabian Peninsula: “A group of Latter-day Saint researchers recently found evidence linking a site in Yemen, on the southwest corner of the Arabian peninsula, to a name associated with Lehi’s journey as recorded in the Book of Mormon.

“Warren Aston, Lynn Hilton, and Gregory Witt located a stone altar that professional archaeologists dated to at least 700 B.C. This altar contains an inscription confirming ‘Nahom’ as an actual place that existed in the peninsula before the time of Lehi” (“News of the Church,” *Ensign*, Feb. 2001, 79). (In [Book of Mormon Student Manual](#): Click on Chapter 5 and do a Google page search using a short phrase from this passage).

E8. Refer to the map “[Possible Route Taken by Lehi’s Family](#)” in the appendix, page 410.)

Read [1 Nephi 16:34–35](#) and then [1 Nephi 17:1](#) and notice the precise directions Nephi gives. Following these directions would take you to a land that fills the description given in the Book of Mormon of the land of “Bountiful”.

E9. 1 Nephi 17:2 “raw meat”:

Paul Cheesman: “On the probable trail which Lehi traveled there are today 118 waterholes, spaced (on the average) eighteen miles apart. It was the custom of experienced travelers in Arabia that they never built a fire, as it could attract the attention of [*sic*] prowling, raiding party. As a result, they ate much of their food raw, as recorded in the Book of Mormon. Attacking and plundering camps still seems to be the chief object of some Arab tribes.” (First Nephi, *The Doctrinal Foundation*, 245)

E10. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin: “I fear that some members of the Lord’s Church ‘live far beneath their privileges’ with regard to the gift of the Holy Ghost. Some are distracted by the things of the world that block out the influence of the Holy Ghost, preventing them from recognizing spiritual promptings.

This is a noisy and busy world that we live in. Remember that being busy is not necessarily being spiritual. If we are not careful, the things of this world can crowd out the things of the Spirit.

“Some are spiritually deadened and past feeling because of their choices to commit sin. Others simply hover in spiritual complacency with no desire to rise above themselves and commune with the Infinite.

“If they would open their hearts to the refining influence of this unspeakable gift of the Holy Ghost, a glorious new spiritual dimension would come to light. Their eyes would gaze upon a vista scarcely imaginable. They could know for themselves things of the Spirit that are choice, precious, and capable of enlarging the soul, expanding the mind, and filling the heart with inexpressible joy.” (“[The Unspeakable Gift](#),” *Ensign*, May 2003, 27)

E11. For the Strength of Youth: “Music can enrich your life. It can edify and inspire you and help you draw closer to Heavenly Father. Music has a profound effect on your mind, spirit, and behavior.

“Choose carefully the music you listen to. Pay attention to how you feel when you are listening. Some music can carry evil and destructive messages. Do not listen to music that encourages immorality or glorifies violence through its lyrics, beat, or intensity. Do not listen to music that uses vulgar or offensive language or promotes evil practices. Such music can dull your spiritual sensitivity.”

“Learn and sing the hymns. Hymns can lift your spirit, move you to righteous action, and help you understand the temptations of the adversary.” ([For the Strength of the Youth: Music and Dancing](#))

E11. Additional Teaching Ideas (from Lesson #1)

2. Sharing the Book of Mormon

“Consult with the bishopric and the ward mission leader about how members can obtain copies of the Book of Mormon to share with nonmember friends and acquaintances.

“In class, suggest that a class goal this year should be to share the Book of Mormon with nonmember friends and acquaintances. Explain to class members how they may obtain copies of the Book of Mormon, and encourage each class member to give a copy to at least one friend or acquaintance during the year.

“Several times during the year, as the Spirit directs, ask class members if any of them have yet shared a copy of the Book of Mormon. Invite class members who have done this to briefly describe the experience. Continue to encourage class members to share the Book of Mormon with others.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Recommended Reading Resources:

1. President Ezra Taft Benson, “[The Book of Mormon—Keystone of our Religion](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986.

2. Elder M. Russell Ballard, “[Small and Simple Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 1990.

3. Boyd K. Packer, “[The Book of Mormon: Another Testament of Jesus Christ—Plain and Precious Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 2005, 6-9.

4. President Marion G. Romney, “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1980, 67).

5. James A. Cullimore (Assistant to the Twelve), “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1976.

6. Neal Rappleye, “[A New Way to Study and Share the Book of Mormon](#),” *Meridian*, December 28, 2015.

This article introduces a new Book of Mormon Resources website: Book of Mormon Central.

7. [Book of Mormon Central.org](#).

8. [2016 Gospel Doctrine—Recommended Resources on the Book of Mormon \(updated\)](#), Ben S., Times and Seasons, December 19, 2015.

9. “[Complexity, Consistency, Ignorance, and Probabilities](#),” Melvin J. Thorne, *Book of Mormon Authorship: Revisited*, Chapter 7.

10. “[Who Called Ishmael’s Burial Place Nahom?](#)” *KnoWhy* #19, January 26, 2016.

11. Nancy Jensen, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **5** 1 Nephi 16-22. Select Nancy Jensen Gospel Doctrine lesson material blog “LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus”.

12. Gerald Smith, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **5** 1 Nephi 16-22. Select Gerald Smith Gospel Doctrine lesson blog “Joel’s Monastery”.

13. Monte Shelley, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select 5) 1 Nephi 16-22. Select Monte Shelley GD Lesson Notes.

14. BYU Studies Quarterly, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select 5) 1 Nephi 16-22. Select BYU Studies GD lesson material.

15. Lenet H. Read, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select 5) 1 Nephi 16-22. Select Lenet Read GD lessons. **Check the asterisk* at the bottom of article for information about their bows.**

16. Lynn M. and Hope A. Hilton, “[In Search of Lehi’s Trail—Part 2: The Journey](#),” *Ensign*, October 1976.

17. Stephen H. Webb, “[Mormonism obsessed with Christ](#),” *First Things*, accessed 1/16/16.

When you read this article by a former evangelical Christian who converted to Catholicism, Ponderize the BKM 3 Quotes: †1 And †2 with it. Stephen H. Webb is professor of religion and philosophy at Wabash College.

18. [Book of Mormon Student Manual – LDS Institute](#)

1 Nephi 16:18. A Bow “Made of Fine Steel” p. 35

1 Nephi 16:34. “The Place Which Was Called *Nahom*” p. 37

1 Nephi 17:4. Why Did It Take Eight Years ... p. 37

Possible Route Taken by Lehi’s Family (Map) p. 38

1 Nephi 18:25. Horses p. 40 “Fossil remains of true horses ...”

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